

Suggested Media Interview Questions

Confidence of The Mob — Updated July 2026

To facilitate a compelling and insightful conversation, the following questions are categorized by theme. These are designed to help hosts and journalists uncover the unique historical and personal layers of this project. Questions marked NEW reflect recent developments in the story.

The Discovery & The Archive

The Attic Find:

You discovered classified IRS Intelligence files that your mother had stored in a box in the family attic in Woburn. What was that initial moment of discovery like, and what was the most shocking document you found?

Authenticity:

The book features rare surveillance photos and original IRS documents. Why was it important to include these visuals rather than just writing a narrative?

Classified History:

How much of what you uncovered was previously unknown to the public or even to historians of the Boston Mob?

The Subject: Fred G. Pastore

The Untouchables:

Your grandfather was the Group Supervisor of the IRS Intelligence Unit and Chief of the Rackets Squad. How did their tactical approach to organized crime differ from the FBI's approach during the same era?

The Confidential Informant Reveal: [NEW]

Robert Kennedy personally demanded your grandfather name his confidential informant, and Fred refused and was ultimately forced to resign from the IRS. You've said the identity of that informant was a family secret for over 60 years. How did you and your cousin Bobby Pastore finally uncover who it was, and what was that moment like when you realized it was Fred's own brother?

Bobby Pastore's Role: [NEW]

Your cousin Bobby Pastore has been a key partner in this research and is the son of the man who turned out to be the secret informant. How has collaborating with Bobby shaped your understanding of the story, and what has this process meant to your family?

The Double Life:

How did Fred balance being a high-level federal agent taking down mob kingpins while maintaining a quiet family life in Arlington, MA?

The New England Underworld

The Formula:

Can you explain the C+R=J formula — Cooperation plus Records equals Jail — that Fred developed? How did that mathematical logic actually dismantle criminal organizations, and why is it still used by the IRS today?

Local Ties:

How did the geography of places like East Boston, the North End, Lexington, and Woburn play into the surveillance and investigations Fred conducted?

Legacy:

Why do you think the story of the mid-20th-century Mob still resonates so strongly with people in the New England area today?

The Story's Momentum**National TV Attention: [NEW]**

WGN-TV's Backstory with Larry Potash recently taped a feature segment on the book, airing later this summer. Larry is a Lynn, Massachusetts native. What was it like bringing Fred's story and documents into a Chicago television studio, and what do you think it says about the story's reach beyond New England?

Film Potential: [NEW]

There has been early discussion about the story's potential as a film or limited series. What elements of Fred's life do you think translate most powerfully to a visual format, and is that something you are actively pursuing?

The Author's Journey**Entrepreneurial Parallels:**

You've been a pioneer in the tech and AI space, co-founding the original link-in-bio platform itsmyurls. How has your background as an entrepreneur and product manager influenced the way you approached researching and building this story?

The Podcast:

A companion podcast, also called Confidence of the Mob, is launching in fall 2026 alongside an author talk at I AM Books in Boston's North End. What can listeners expect from the podcast that they won't find in the book?

Family Legacy:

As a father raising your kids in Woburn, the same area where these stories took place, how has this project changed your perspective on your family's history and what you want to pass on?